

COMPLETE CHESS LEARNING LIBRARY

The Complete Bishop's Opening

Flexible development, transpositions, central breaks, and attacking setups

COURSE BOOK

30 focused chapters - model positions - decision rules - retrieval practice

Designed to change what you notice, calculate, remember, and do at the board.

How to Use This Course

ONE CHAPTER, FOUR PASSES

1. Read the position without moving pieces. 2. State your plan and the opponent's counterplay. 3. Study the decision rules. 4. Close the book and reconstruct the position from memory.

RETRIEVAL SCHEDULE

Review the chapter the next day, one week later, and after a game that reaches a similar structure. Retrieval is more valuable than rereading.

BOARD ROUTINE

Opponent's threat - forcing moves - loose pieces - worst piece - central break - best reply - choose and stop.

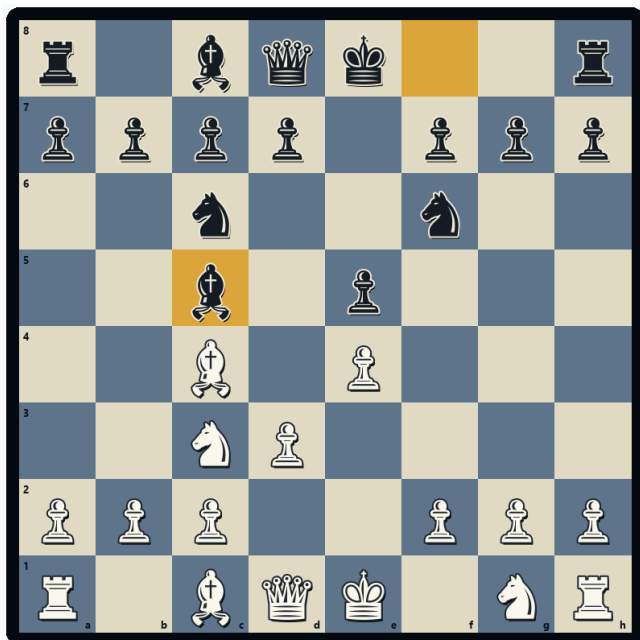
The course book explains each model position. The separate workbook forces recall, prediction, and self-scoring. Use the book first, then attempt the matching workbook page without looking back.

Engine evaluations are intentionally not the lesson. The aim is to store human decision rules that remain useful when the exact move order changes.

Course Map

MODULE	CHAPTERS
02 - Quiet Bishop's Opening	6
03 - Italian and Vienna Transpositions	5
04 - White Gambits	5
05 - Black Countergambits	4
06 - Early Black Sidelines	6
07 - Active White Systems	3
08 - Structures and Repertoire Choices	1

01. Classical Nc6 Setup



02 - Quiet Bishop's Opening

READ THE POSITION

Both sides develop naturally while White keeps the g1-knight and f-pawn flexible.

PRIMARY PLAN

Castle, improve the kingside knight, and prepare d4 without blocking the c1-bishop.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black completes development and seeks ...d5 or ...Na5 against the bishop.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 Nc6 3. d3 Nf6 4. Nc3 Bc5

MEMORY RULE

Classical Bishop's: flexibility is useful only when it leads to d4.

01. Decision Framework

Classical Nc6 Setup

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	A routine Nf3 can walk into ...Nxe4 if d4 tactics remove the defender.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

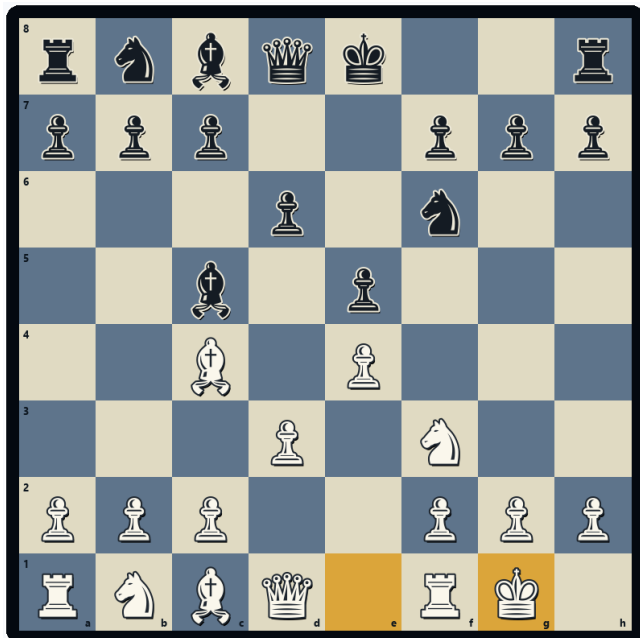
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Classical Bishop's: flexibility is useful only when it leads to d4.

02. Berlin Defense Quiet Line



02 - Quiet Bishop's Opening

READ THE POSITION

Black attacks e4 immediately and White supports it with a compact d3 center.

PRIMARY PLAN

Castle, use c3 and Re1, and prepare a well-supported d4 break.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black seeks ...O-O, ...c6, and ...d5 while the center remains stable.

REFERENCE LINE 1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 Nf6 3. d3 Bc5 4. Nf3 d6 5. O-O

MEMORY RULE

Quiet Berlin: defend e4, then earn the d4 break.

02. Decision Framework

Berlin Defense Quiet Line

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Do not attack f7 while e4 is loose to the f6-knight.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

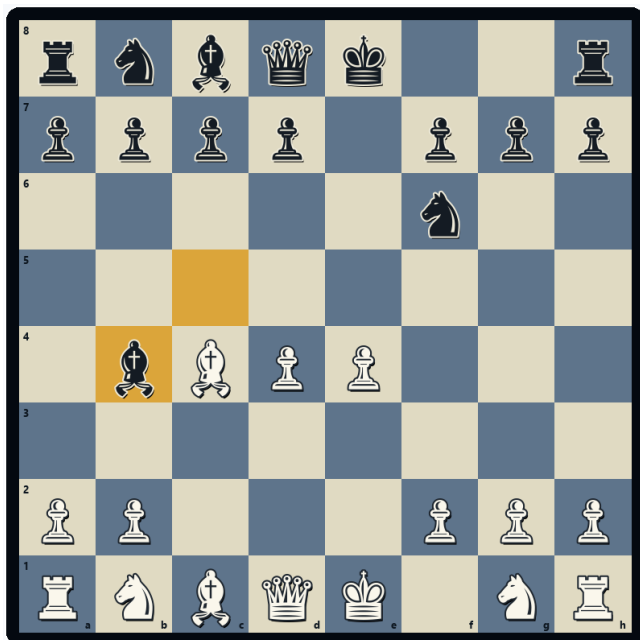
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Quiet Berlin: defend e4, then earn the d4 break.

03. Boi Variation



02 - Quiet Bishop's Opening

READ THE POSITION

Both bishops point toward the center and White prepares c3-d4 in one move.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use the broad center to gain time, but answer the bishop check without losing e4.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black opens the center and checks on b4 before White castles.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 Bc5 3. c3 Nf6 4. d4 exd4 5. cxd4 Bb4+

MEMORY RULE

Boi: build the center only when the check on b4 has an answer.

03. Decision Framework

Boi Variation

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	The d4 advance can expose the king and the e4 pawn simultaneously.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

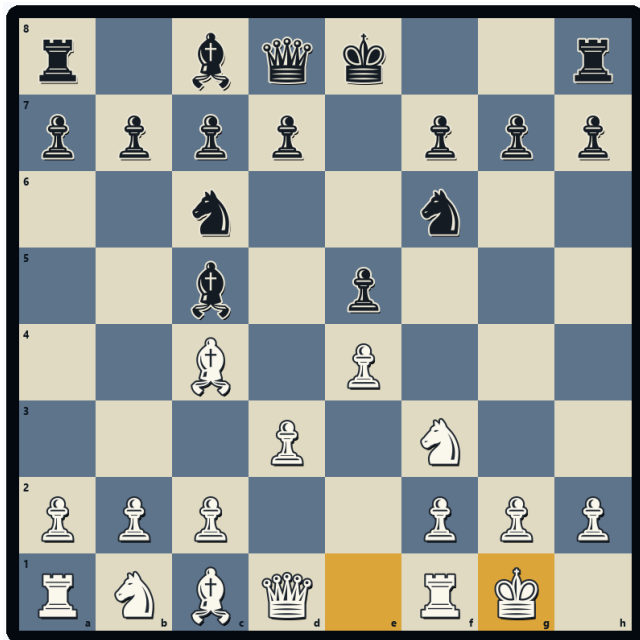
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Boi: build the center only when the check on b4 has an answer.

04. Italian Game Transposition



03 - Italian and Vienna Transpositions

READ THE POSITION

White's move order becomes a quiet Italian once Nf3 and ...Nc6 appear.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use c3, Re1, and Nbd2-f1 while preparing d4.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black uses ...d6, ...O-O, and ...a6 or ...d5 to equalize.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 Nc6 3. Nf3 Bc5 4. d3 Nf6 5. O-O

MEMORY RULE

Transposition rule: study the position you reached, not the name you started with.

04. Decision Framework

Italian Game Transposition

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Do not pretend the position is still independent Bishop's theory after the transposition.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

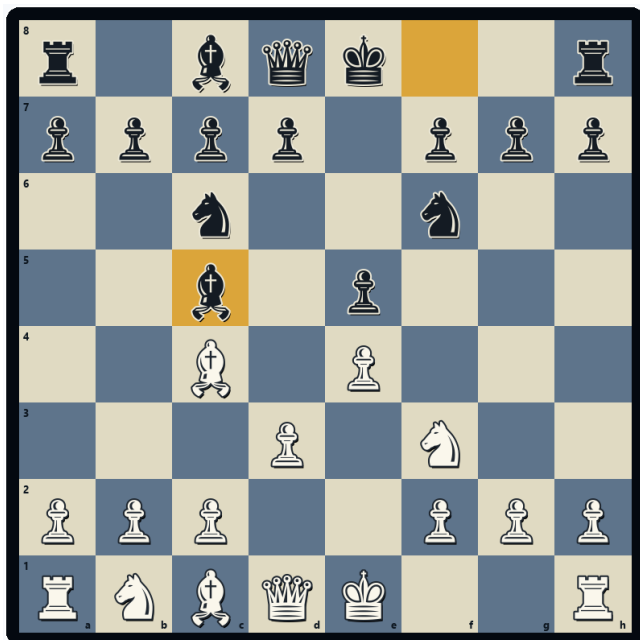
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Transposition rule: study the position you reached, not the name you started with.

05. Four Knights Transposition



03 - Italian and Vienna Transpositions

READ THE POSITION

Both knights develop and the position enters an Italian Four Knights structure.

PRIMARY PLAN

Castle and choose between Nc3-d5 pressure and a c3-d4 center.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black can use ...d6, ...O-O, and ...Be6 to neutralize the c4-bishop.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 Nf6 3. d3 Nc6 4. Nf3 Bc5

MEMORY RULE

Four Knights: choose Nc3 only when c3 is no longer essential.

05. Decision Framework

Four Knights Transposition

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Nc3 can block the c-pawn, so decide the central structure first.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

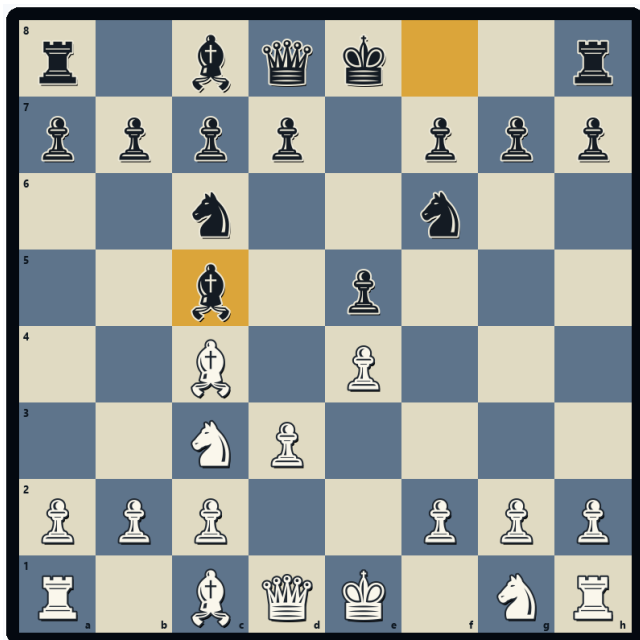
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Four Knights: choose Nc3 only when c3 is no longer essential.

06. Vienna Hybrid



03 - Italian and Vienna Transpositions

READ THE POSITION

White develops the queen knight first and keeps the g1-knight flexible for f3 or e2.

PRIMARY PLAN

Choose f4 for sharp play or Nf3 for a classical center according to Black's king.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black develops quickly and can strike with ...d5.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 Nf6 3. Nc3 Nc6 4. d3 Bc5

MEMORY RULE

Vienna hybrid: the knight choice defines whether f4 is safe.

06. Decision Framework

Vienna Hybrid

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Playing f4 while the center opens can expose the white king before castling.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

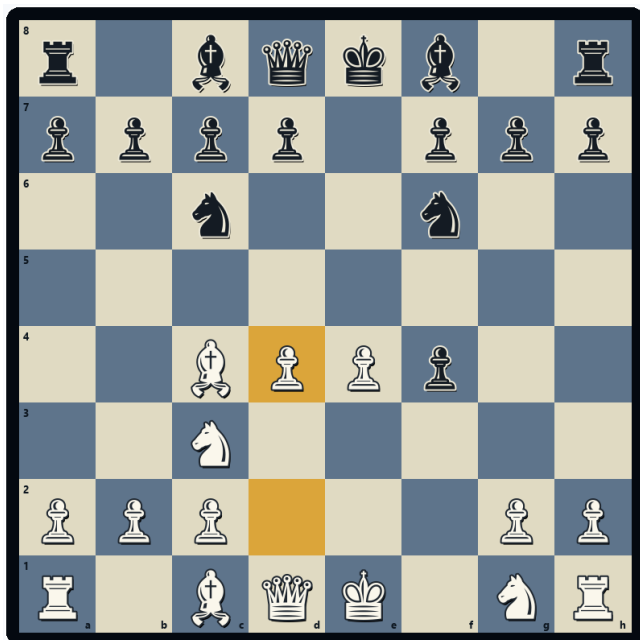
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Vienna hybrid: the knight choice defines whether f4 is safe.

07. Vienna Gambit Transition



03 - Italian and Vienna Transpositions

READ THE POSITION

White uses the Bishop's move order to reach a Vienna Gambit with the bishop already aimed at f7.

PRIMARY PLAN

Open the center with d4 and use rapid development as the compensation.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black holds f4, counterattacks the center, and seeks ...Bb4 or ...d5.

REFERENCE LINE 1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 Nf6 3. Nc3 Nc6 4. f4 exf4 5. d4

MEMORY RULE

Vienna transition: use the open center before chasing the gambit pawn.

07. Decision Framework

Vienna Gambit Transition

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Do not spend time recovering f4 if the central initiative is the real compensation.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

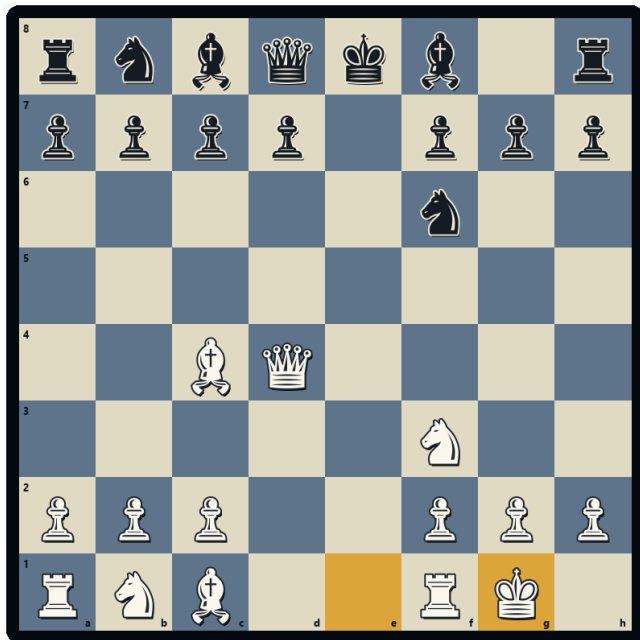
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Vienna transition: use the open center before chasing the gambit pawn.

08. Urusov Gambit



04 - White Gambits

READ THE POSITION

White offers central material to gain development and open lines against the king.

PRIMARY PLAN

Castle quickly, occupy the e-file, and make each move increase a threat or development lead.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black returns the knight, consolidates, and seeks ...d5 to return material under favorable terms.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 Nf6 3. d4 exd4 4. Nf3 Nxe4 5. Qxd4 Nf6 6. O-O

MEMORY RULE

Urusov: compensation is open lines plus tempi, not the gambit's name.

08. Decision Framework

Urusov Gambit

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	The gambit fails if White spends queen tempi while Black develops with attacks.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

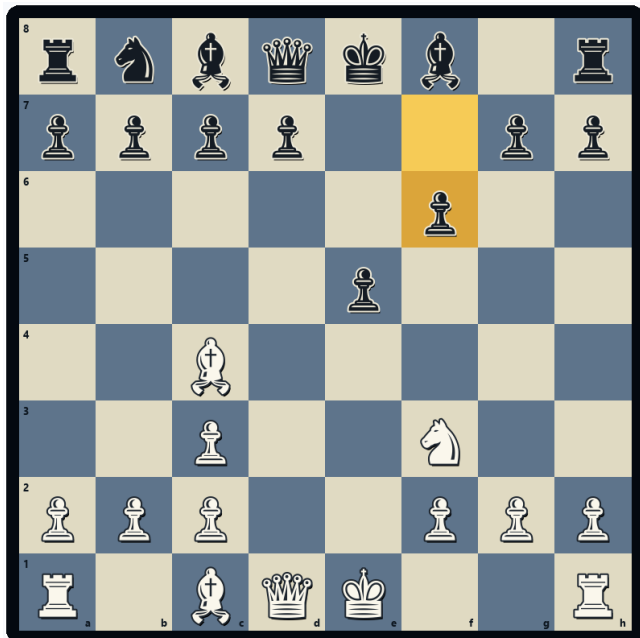
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Urusov: compensation is open lines plus tempi, not the gambit's name.

09. Boden-Kieseritzky Gambit



04 - White Gambits

READ THE POSITION

White accepts doubled c-pawns to open lines and accelerate development after Black takes e4.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use the bishop pair, open d-file, and rapid castling to attack the uncastled king.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black keeps the extra pawn and builds a compact center with ...d6.

REFERENCE LINE 1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 Nf6 3. Nf3 Nxe4 4. Nc3 Nxc3 5. dxc3 f6

MEMORY RULE

Boden-Kieseritzky: the open file must work before the pawns become weak.

09. Decision Framework

Boden-Kieseritzky Gambit

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Doubled pawns are compensation only if the open lines are used immediately.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

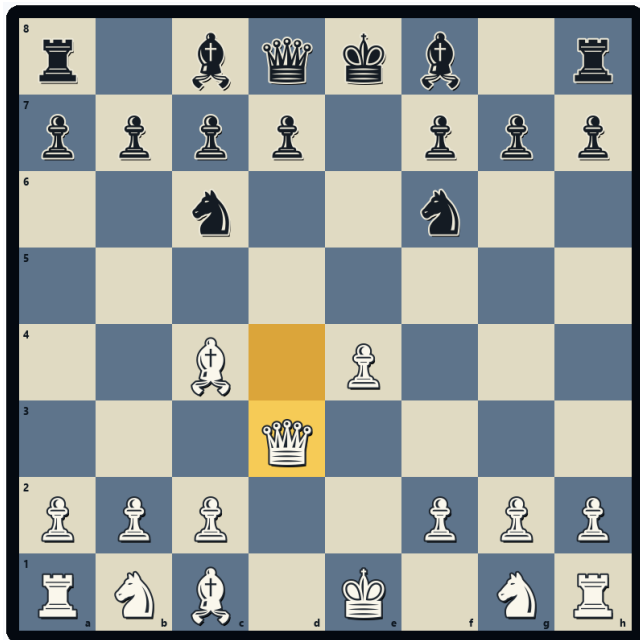
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Boden-Kieseritzky: the open file must work before the pawns become weak.

10. Ponziani Center Gambit



04 - White Gambits

READ THE POSITION

White recaptures with the queen to keep a central pawn but risks losing development tempi.

PRIMARY PLAN

Retreat the queen to a useful square and complete development before seeking tactics on f7.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black develops with tempo and uses ...Ne5 or ...d5 against the queen and bishop.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 Nf6 3. d4 exd4 4. Qxd4 Nc6 5. Qd3

MEMORY RULE

Ponziani center: the queen must retreat toward development, not merely safety.

10. Decision Framework

Ponziani Center Gambit

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	A queen that recovers a pawn can become the opponent's development tool.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

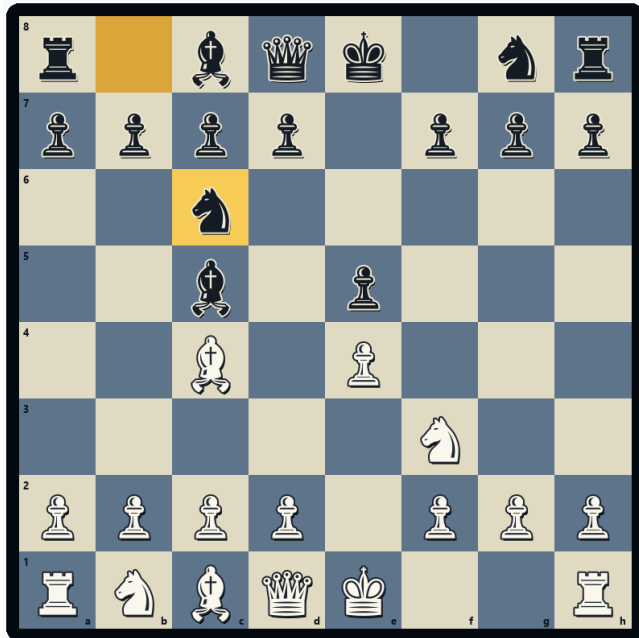
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Ponziani center: the queen must retreat toward development, not merely safety.

11. Lewis Gambit Decision Point



04 - White Gambits

READ THE POSITION

White reaches the decision whether to offer d4 for rapid development or transpose to a normal Italian setup.

PRIMARY PLAN

Compare d4 with quiet castling by calculating whether open lines will bring every piece into play.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black can accept on d4 and consolidate with ...Nf6, or decline by striking the center.

REFERENCE LINE 1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 Bc5 3. Nf3 Nc6

MEMORY RULE

Lewis decision: offer d4 only when open lines will repay the pawn.

11. Decision Framework

Lewis Gambit Decision Point

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	The gambit becomes dubious when White adds queen moves instead of bringing pieces.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

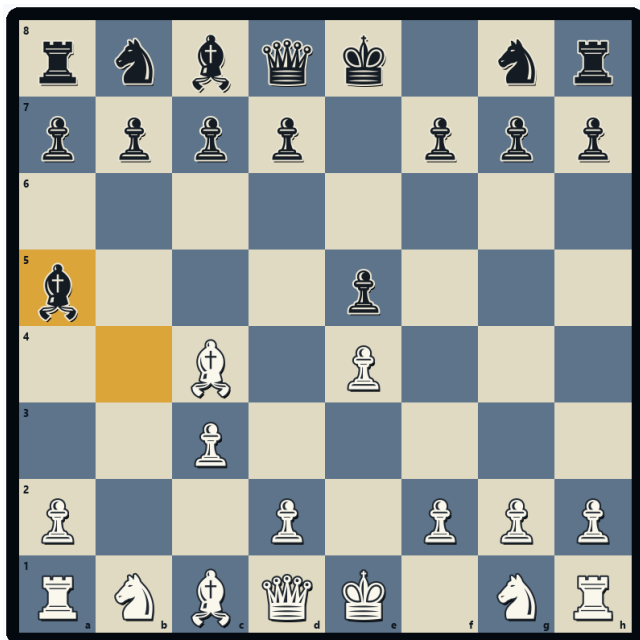
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Lewis decision: offer d4 only when open lines will repay the pawn.

12. Wing Gambit



04 - White Gambits

READ THE POSITION

White offers the b-pawn to gain c3 and d4 with tempo against the bishop.

PRIMARY PLAN

Build the center rapidly and castle before Black consolidates the extra pawn.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black keeps the bishop active and attacks the center with ...Nf6 and ...d5.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 Bc5 3. b4 Bxb4 4. c3 Ba5

MEMORY RULE

Wing Gambit: the pawn buys a center, so build it immediately.

12. Decision Framework

Wing Gambit

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	If d4 is delayed, White has simply weakened the queenside.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

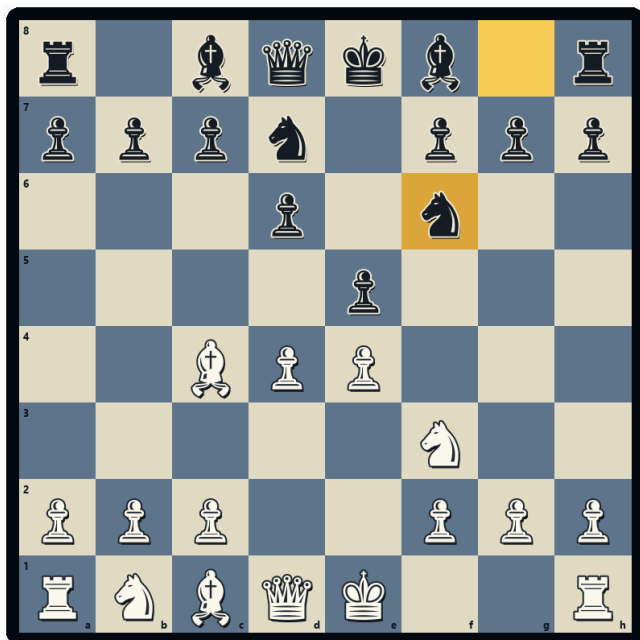
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Wing Gambit: the pawn buys a center, so build it immediately.

13. Philidor Setup



02 - Quiet Bishop's Opening

READ THE POSITION

Black protects e5 with a compact Philidor shell and delays active development.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use space to improve pieces and prevent ...d5 or ...f5 without overextending.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black seeks a freeing pawn break after completing development.

REFERENCE LINE 1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 d6 3. d4 Nd7 4. Nf3 Ngf6

MEMORY RULE

Philidor setup: space should prevent a break and improve a piece.

13. Decision Framework

Philidor Setup

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Pushing too many central pawns can give Black targets instead of restriction.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

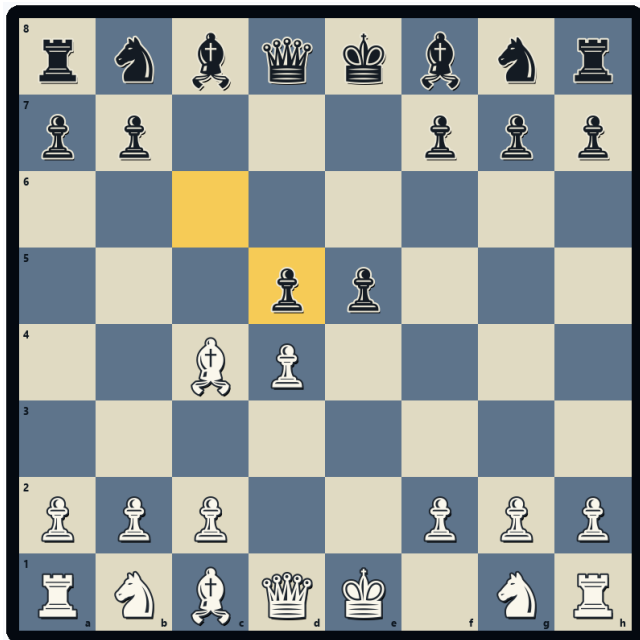
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Philidor setup: space should prevent a break and improve a piece.

14. Philidor Counterattack ...c6



05 - Black Countergambits

READ THE POSITION

Black prepares an immediate ...d5 challenge and asks White to clarify the bishop and center.

PRIMARY PLAN

Keep the bishop safe, use Bb3, and decide whether dxe5 or exd5 yields the better structure.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black gains central space and development tempo against the c4-bishop.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 c6 3. d4 d5 4. exd5 cxd5

MEMORY RULE

Against ...c6: preserve the bishop and judge the central exchange first.

14. Decision Framework

Philidor Counterattack ...c6

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	The bishop can be trapped or lose time if White opens the center carelessly.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

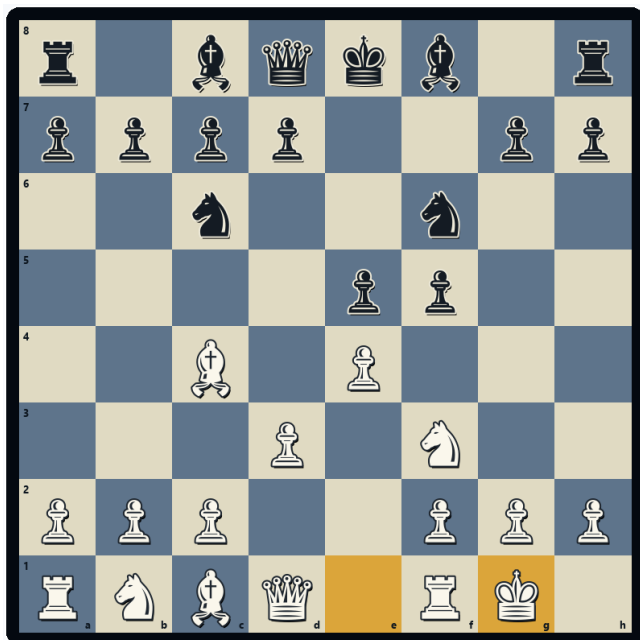
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Against ...c6: preserve the bishop and judge the central exchange first.

15. Calabrese Countergambit



05 - Black Countergambits

READ THE POSITION

Black attacks e4 immediately with the f-pawn and accepts weakened king squares.

PRIMARY PLAN

Keep the center stable, develop, and exploit dark-square weaknesses after Black commits.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black seeks ...fxe4, ...Bc5, and rapid kingside activity.

REFERENCE LINE 1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 f5 3. d3 Nf6 4. Nf3 Nc6 5. O-O

MEMORY RULE

Calabrese: secure the center, then use the holes left by ...f5.

15. Decision Framework

Calabrese Countergambit

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	A premature exf5 can open lines for Black's pieces rather than win a safe pawn.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

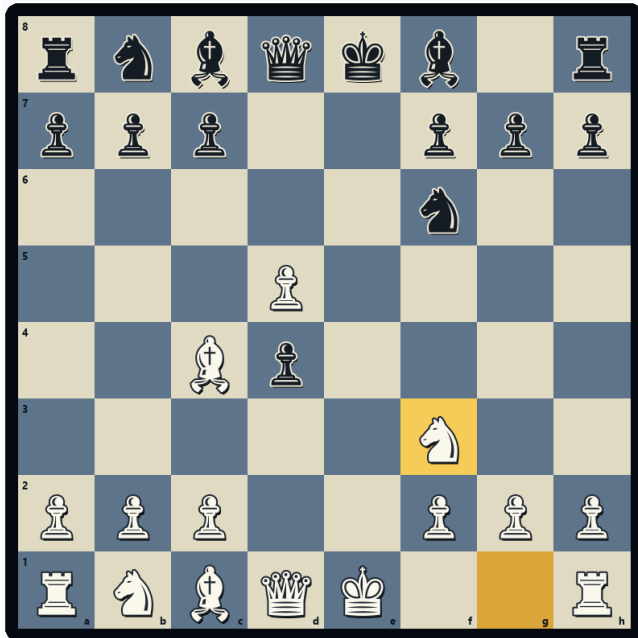
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Calabrese: secure the center, then use the holes left by ...f5.

16. Khan Gambit ...d5



05 - Black Counter gambits

READ THE POSITION

Black challenges the bishop and center immediately, offering rapid development for a pawn.

PRIMARY PLAN

Finish development and decide whether the extra pawn can be kept without blocking the pieces.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black uses ...Nxd5 and ...Bb4+ to regain material with tempo.

REFERENCE LINE 1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 d5 3. exd5 Nf6 4. d4 exd4 5. Nf3

MEMORY RULE

Khan: development decides whether the pawn is extra or poisoned.

16. Decision Framework

Khan Gambit ...d5

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Trying to hold every pawn can leave the king in the center.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

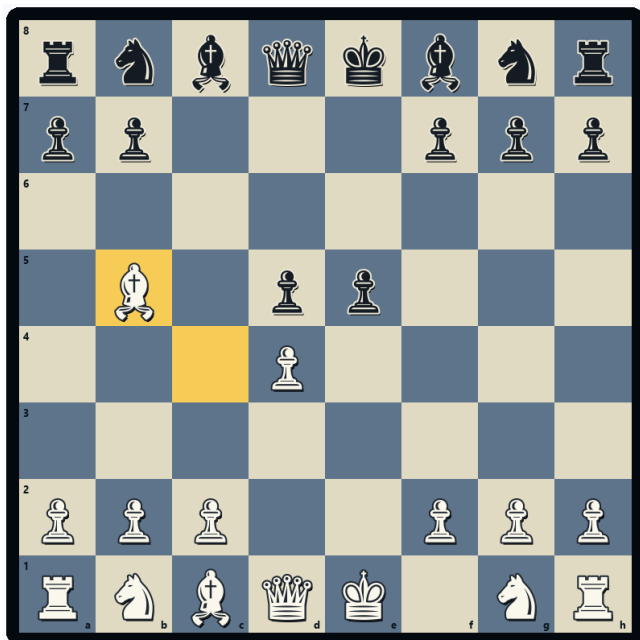
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Khan: development decides whether the pawn is extra or poisoned.

17. Early ...c6 and ...d5



05 - Black Countergambits

READ THE POSITION

Black builds a direct central challenge and may gain space against the bishop.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use the check to influence development, then attack the isolated or hanging center.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black uses ...Nc6 and ...e4 to gain tempi against White's pieces.

REFERENCE LINE 1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 c6 3. d4 d5 4. exd5 cxd5 5. Bb5+

MEMORY RULE

...c6 and ...d5: make the central pawn a target after development.

17. Decision Framework

Early ...c6 and ...d5

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Checks that do not improve development can merely move Black's king bishop to a better square.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

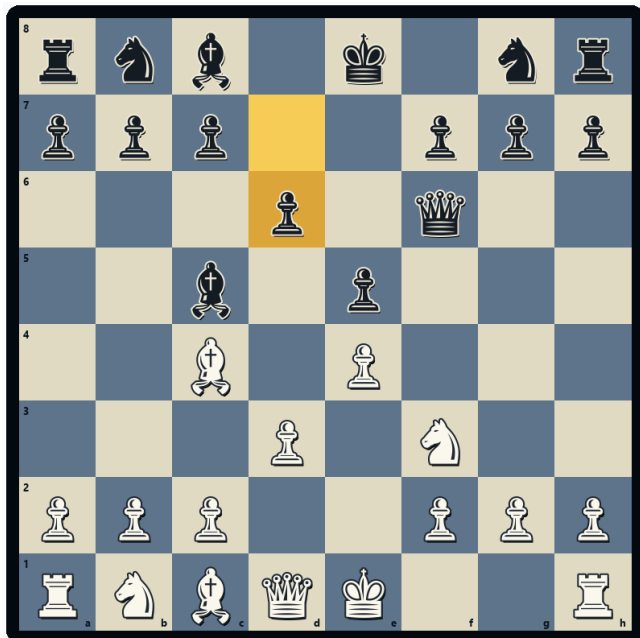
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: ...c6 and ...d5: make the central pawn a target after development.

18. Early ...Qf6



06 - Early Black Sidelines

READ THE POSITION

Black defends e5 and creates primitive pressure on f2 with the queen and bishop.

PRIMARY PLAN

Develop Nf3, castle, and gain time on the queen only when the move improves a piece.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black may use ...Qg6 or ...Ne7 while threatening tactical ideas on f2.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 Qf6 3. d3 Bc5 4. Nf3 d6

MEMORY RULE

Against ...Qf6: defend by developing and let the queen become awkward.

18. Decision Framework

Early ...Qf6

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Do not weaken the kingside merely to attack the queen.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

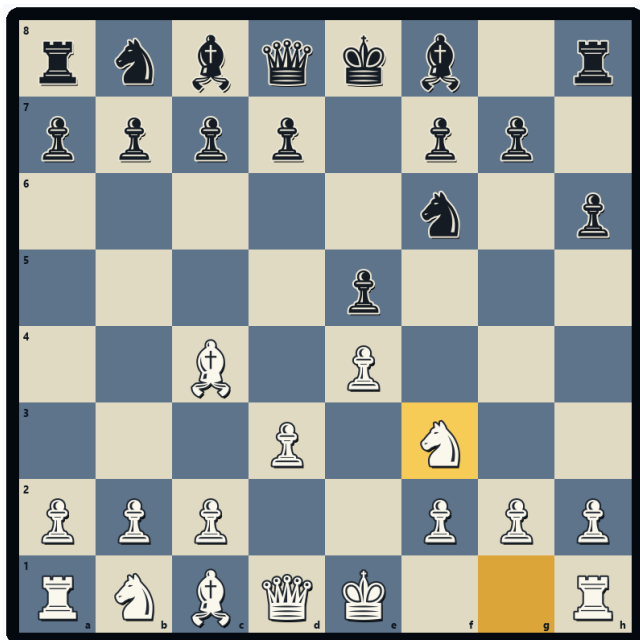
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Against ...Qf6: defend by developing and let the queen become awkward.

19. Early ...h6



06 - Early Black Sidelines

READ THE POSITION

Black spends a tempo preventing Bg5 without challenging the center.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use the free tempo for development and prepare d4 before starting an attack.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black still seeks normal ...Nf6, ...Bc5, and ...d5 play.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 h6 3. d3 Nf6 4. Nf3

MEMORY RULE

Against ...h6: take the center, not the bait of premature attack.

19. Decision Framework

Early ...h6

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Punishing a slow move does not mean launching an unsound sacrifice.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

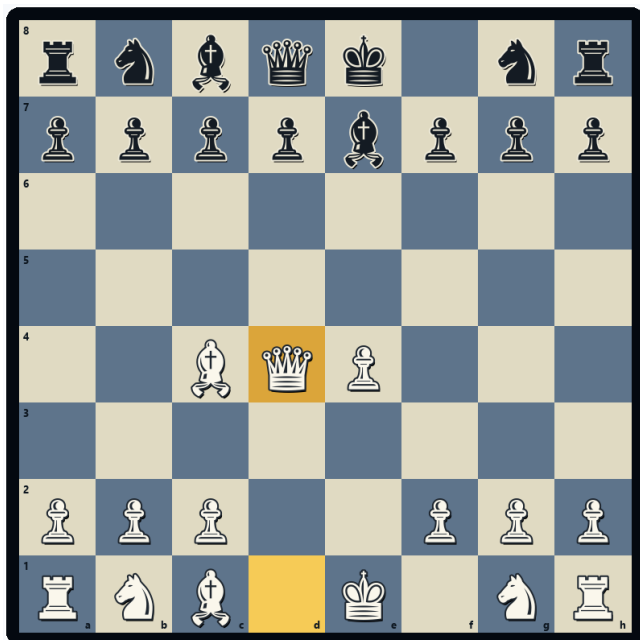
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Against ...h6: take the center, not the bait of premature attack.

20. Early ...Be7



06 - Early Black Sidelines

READ THE POSITION

Black chooses a modest bishop square and invites White to occupy the center.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use d4 with development, then move the queen only to a square that supports castling.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black attacks the queen with ...Nc6 and seeks ...Nf6.

REFERENCE LINE 1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 Be7 3. d4 exd4 4. Qxd4

MEMORY RULE

Against ...Be7: central space is useful when the queen does not become a target.

20. Decision Framework

Early ...Be7

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Qxd4 can give Black free development if the queen has no stable square.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

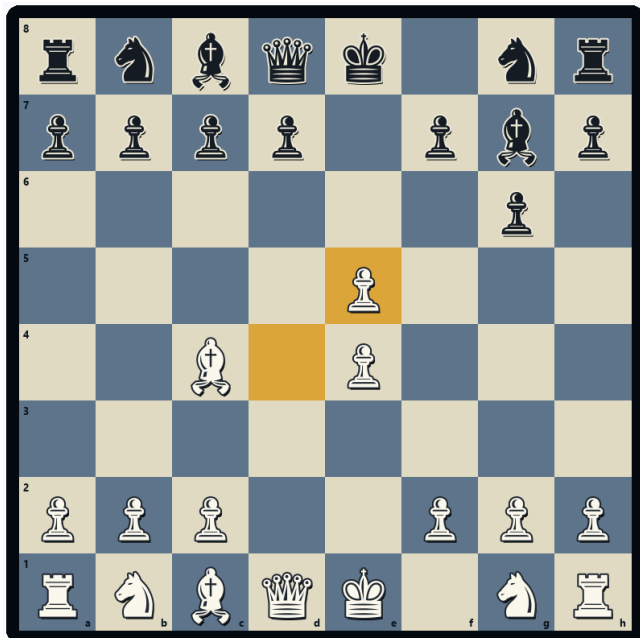
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Against ...Be7: central space is useful when the queen does not become a target.

21. Early ...g6



06 - Early Black Sidelines

READ THE POSITION

Black fianchettoes but delays pressure on e4 and central development.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use the center and develop before trying to exploit the dark squares.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black uses ...Nf6 and ...d6 to recover e5 and pressure the center.

REFERENCE LINE 1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 g6 3. d4 Bg7 4. dxe5

MEMORY RULE

Against ...g6: occupy the center and make Black prove the recovery.

21. Decision Framework

Early ...g6

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Taking e5 can lose time if Black regains it with a developing move.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

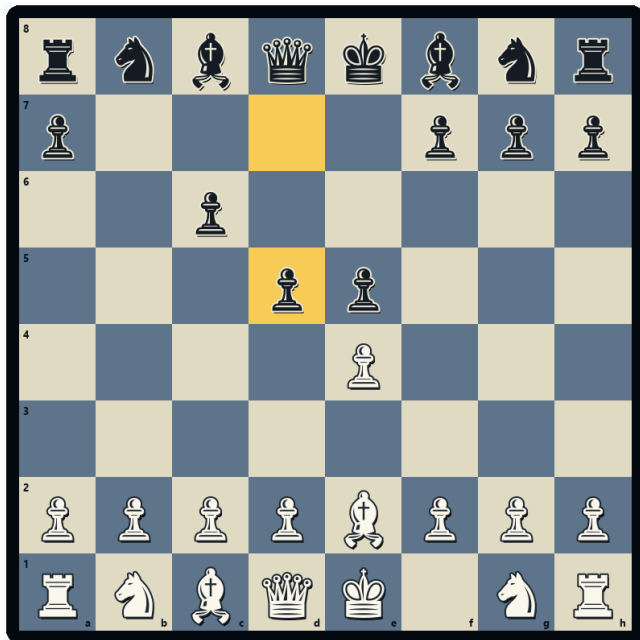
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Against ...g6: occupy the center and make Black prove the recovery.

22. Early ...b5



06 - Early Black Sidelines

READ THE POSITION

Black offers a queenside pawn to gain tempi against the bishop and build a broad center.

PRIMARY PLAN

Return the bishop safely and attack the center before Black's development catches up.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black uses ...d5 and ...Nf6 to make the bishop lose time.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 b5 3. Bxb5 c6 4. Be2 d5

MEMORY RULE

Against ...b5: the center matters more than holding the pawn.

22. Decision Framework

Early ...b5

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Keeping the pawn can trap the bishop or leave White far behind in development.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

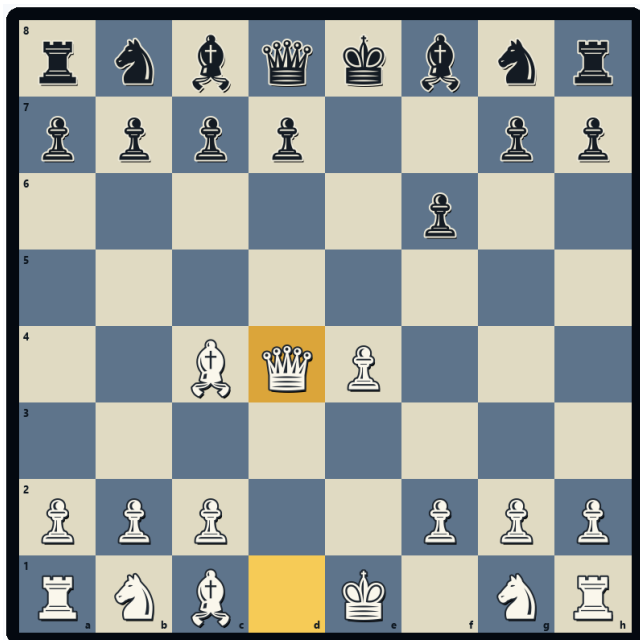
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Against ...b5: the center matters more than holding the pawn.

23. Early ...f6



06 - Early Black Sidelines

READ THE POSITION

Black overprotects e5 but weakens the king and blocks the g8-knight.

PRIMARY PLAN

Open lines with d4, develop rapidly, and avoid unnecessary queen adventures.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black attacks the queen and tries to build ...d6 before the weaknesses matter.

REFERENCE LINE 1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 f6 3. d4 exd4 4. Qxd4

MEMORY RULE

Against ...f6: open the center with pieces ready, not with wishful sacrifices.

23. Decision Framework

Early ...f6

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	An unsound sacrifice on f7 can help Black's king escape to safety.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

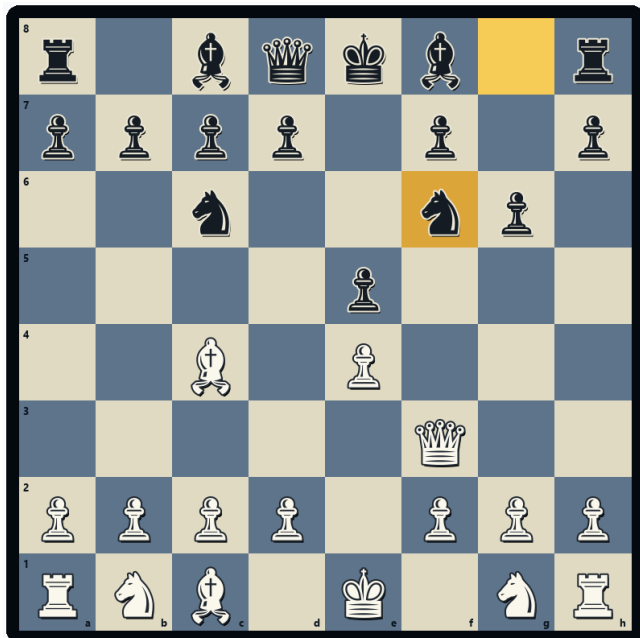
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Against ...f6: open the center with pieces ready, not with wishful sacrifices.

24. Early Qh5 Pressure



07 - Active White Systems

READ THE POSITION

White creates an immediate f7 threat but commits the queen before development.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use the threat to provoke concessions, then retreat and develop without insisting on mate.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black covers f7, attacks the queen, and gains tempi with ...Nf6.

REFERENCE LINE 1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 Nc6 3. Qh5 g6 4. Qf3 Nf6

MEMORY RULE

Early Qh5: take a concession, then return to development.

24. Decision Framework

Early Qh5 Pressure

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Scholar's-mate thinking becomes a liability once Black develops with tempo.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

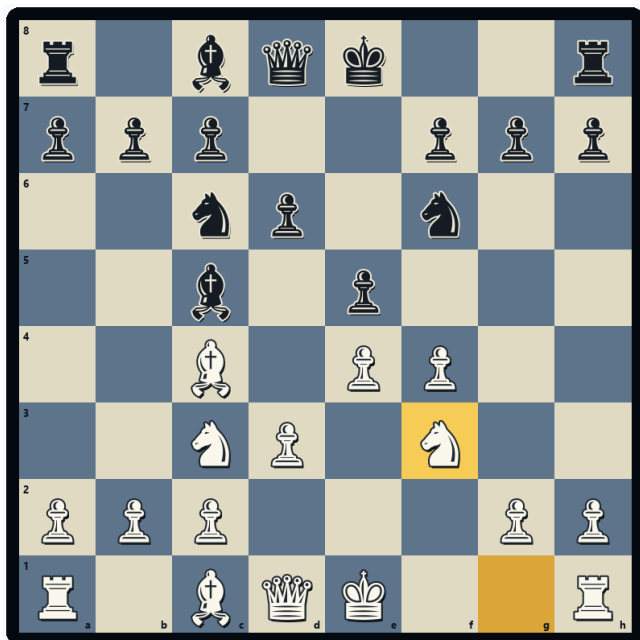
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Early Qh5: take a concession, then return to development.

25. Kingside f4 Plan



07 - Active White Systems

READ THE POSITION

White develops first and only then uses a Vienna-style kingside expansion.

PRIMARY PLAN

Prepare f5 or castling while ensuring the center cannot open against the king.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black strikes with ...d5 or ...exf4 and uses the weakened diagonal.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 Nc6 3. d3 Nf6 4. Nc3 Bc5 5. f4 d6 6. Nf3

MEMORY RULE

f4 plan: develop the center's defenders before opening the wing.

25. Decision Framework

Kingside f4 Plan

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	The f-pawn move removes a king defender, so development must come first.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

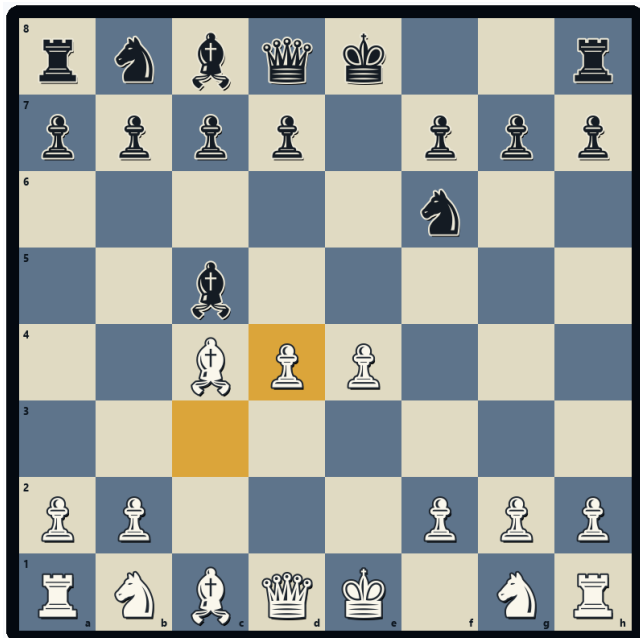
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: f4 plan: develop the center's defenders before opening the wing.

26. Classical c3-d4 Center



07 - Active White Systems

READ THE POSITION

White builds a broad center and gains time against the c5-bishop.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use the space to develop Nc3 and castle while keeping e4 defended.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black uses ...Bb4+, ...d5, or ...Nxe4 to attack the center.

REFERENCE LINE 1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 Bc5 3. c3 Nf6 4. d4 exd4 5. cxd4

MEMORY RULE

c3-d4: count defenders after the bishop check.

26. Decision Framework

Classical c3-d4 Center

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	A broad center can collapse when one pawn is pinned and another is loose.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

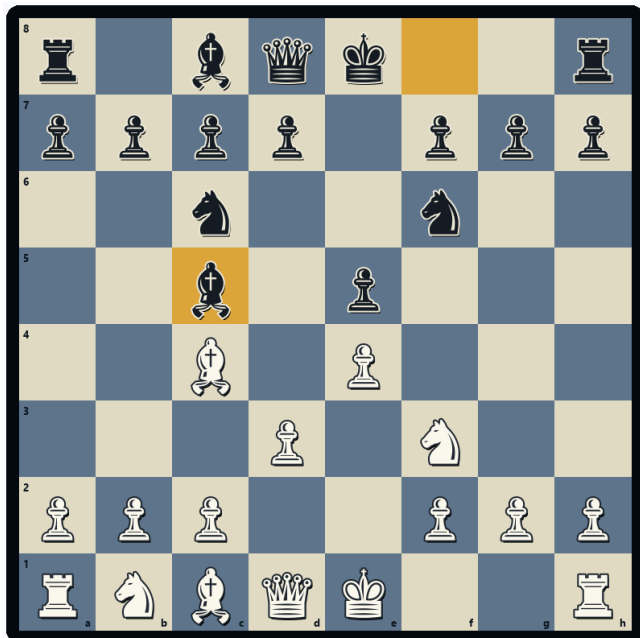
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: c3-d4: count defenders after the bishop check.

27. Nf3 Direct Transposition



03 - Italian and Vienna Transpositions

READ THE POSITION

White immediately commits to Nf3 and enters an Italian structure.

PRIMARY PLAN

Treat the position as an Italian: castle, use c3, and prepare d4.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black develops symmetrically and may use ...d5 in one move.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 Nf6 3. Nf3 Nc6 4. d3 Bc5

MEMORY RULE

Nf3 transposition: switch the mental file to the Italian.

27. Decision Framework

Nf3 Direct Transposition

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	The opening name has changed; using Bishop's-only habits can misplace the pieces.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

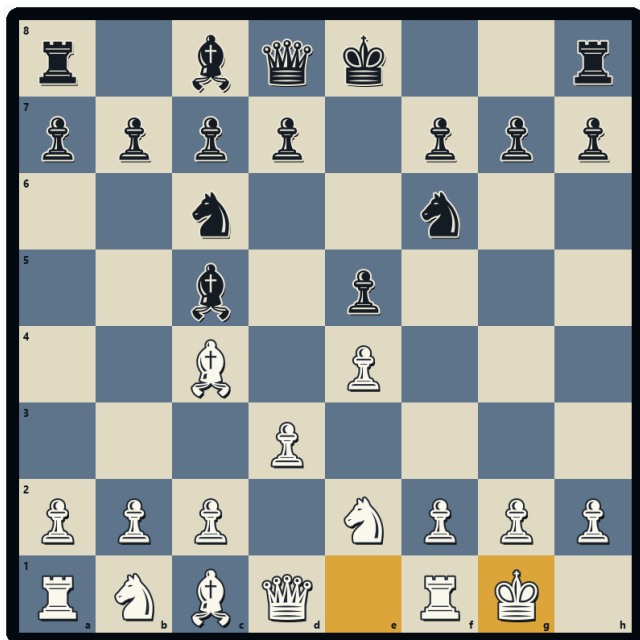
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Nf3 transposition: switch the mental file to the Italian.

28. Ne2 Flexible Setup



02 - Quiet Bishop's Opening

READ THE POSITION

White develops the knight to e2, keeping the f-pawn free and avoiding blocks on c3.

PRIMARY PLAN

Prepare f4 or c3-d4 while rerouting the knight to g3.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black uses ...d5 before White completes the slower maneuver.

REFERENCE LINE 1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 Nc6 3. d3 Nf6 4. Ne2 Bc5 5. O-O

MEMORY RULE

Ne2 setup: flexibility must become a timely pawn break.

28. Decision Framework

Ne2 Flexible Setup

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Ne2 is flexible but passive if White never uses f4 or d4.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

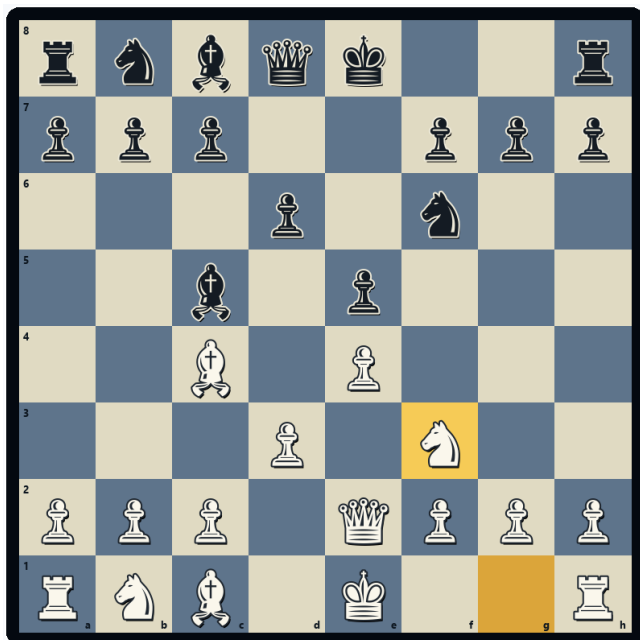
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Ne2 setup: flexibility must become a timely pawn break.

29. Qe2 Support System



02 - Quiet Bishop's Opening

READ THE POSITION

White supports e4 with the queen and keeps the f-pawn and knight routes flexible.

PRIMARY PLAN

Castle, choose Nf3 or Nc3, and use Qe2 to support d4 or kingside castling.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black develops with tempo and may use ...Bg4 against the queen-knight alignment.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 Nf6 3. d3 Bc5 4. Qe2 d6 5. Nf3

MEMORY RULE

Qe2 system: queen support is useful only when it enables the next break.

29. Decision Framework

Qe2 Support System

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	The queen on e2 can obstruct the bishop or rook if the setup lacks a clear purpose.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

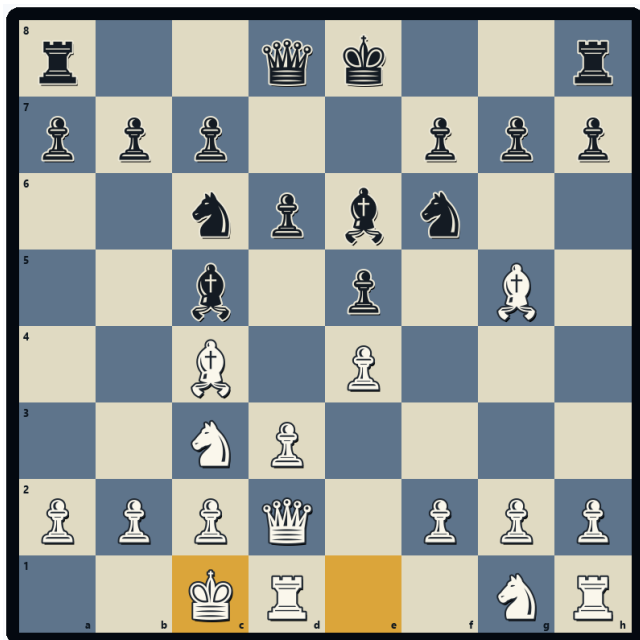
ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Qe2 system: queen support is useful only when it enables the next break.

30. Opposite-Castling System



08 - Structures and Repertoire Choices

READ THE POSITION

White clears the queenside and castles long to create a sharper attacking game.

PRIMARY PLAN

Use f4 and kingside pawns only after securing c2 and the open queenside files.

OPPONENT'S COUNTERPLAY

Black attacks the long-castled king with ...a6, ...b5, and central breaks.

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Bc4 Nc6 3. Nc3 Nf6 4. d3 Bc5 5. Bg5 d6 6. Qd2 Be6 7. O-O-O

MEMORY RULE

Long castling: attack only after checking the c-file and central king lines.

30. Decision Framework

Opposite-Castling System

PAWN BREAK / TRANSFORMATION	Prepare the central break with development; calculate the forced recapture and the first open-line move.
PIECE JOB	Give every piece a job that supports the center or the critical break.
TACTICAL WARNING	Opposite-side castling makes every central opening a calculation problem.
TRADE FILTER	Exchange only when the favorable feature survives the trade.
ENDGAME FORECAST	Simplify only when the healthier structure, better minor piece, or more active king survives the trade.
CLOCK RULE	Spend time on forcing or irreversible decisions; move efficiently in familiar structures.

ACTIVE RECALL

1. Without looking back, describe the center and the position's main imbalance.
2. What is your first useful plan, and which piece must improve before the pawn break?
3. What is the opponent's best freeing move or tactical resource?
4. Which exchange helps, which exchange helps the opponent, and what survives into the ending?
5. State the memory rule in your own words and name one trigger that would change the plan.

NEXT-GAME ASSIGNMENT

If a similar structure appears, pause before the first irreversible decision and use this rule: Long castling: attack only after checking the c-file and central king lines.

Course Completion Test

Choose ten chapters at random. Rebuild each reference position, name both sides' plans, identify the critical break, and state the trade filter without reopening the chapter.

Score one point for the structure, one for your plan, one for counterplay, one for the break, and one for the memory rule. Forty out of fifty means the knowledge is usable; below forty means retrieval practice should continue.

FINAL PRINCIPLE

A course is complete when its ideas appear in your decisions, not when its pages have been read.